

BLUE BOOK AT GETHIA, NAINITAL

An 18-km (about 45 mins) winding uphill drive from Nainital brings you to Blue Book by Gethia, a quaint 1890s bungalow with eight rooms all done up in Victorian style with floral upholstery. Four additional Mediterranean-style rooms are in the new wing, a late 20th-century addition. Meals range from North Indian and Kumaoni to pan-Asian and Continental, served either in the cosy dining room or around the property or further afield, like a picnic in the surrounding wilderness or a riverside high tea. Other experiences include scenic hikes, birding and visits to nearby temples like Kasar Devi and Chitai Golu Devta.

Doubles from ₹13,000; bluebookhotels.com

The Elgin, Darjeeling

Built in 1887, The Elgin was once the summer residence of the Maharajah of Cooch Behar. The sprawling green-roofed manor house practically oozes old-world charm with its oak wood panelling, period Burma teak furniture, crackling fireplaces and a grand piano. In all, 25 well-equipped rooms are done up in charming Victorian décor and come with a sitting area and a working fireplace. Most rooms look out over the landscaped garden and the mountains (no Kanchenjunga views though). An inhouse spa offers a range of massages and beauty treatments. The hotel is located within walking distance of the Darjeeling Mall (High Street) lined with cafes, restaurants and bars.

Doubles from ₹13,000; elginhotels.com

